Sous vide boeuf bourguignon

Beef chuck in reduced red wine, 24 hours at 68 °C

Serves 4 · **Prep** 45 min · **Cook** 24 h · Adapted from recipes.anovaculinary.com

Sous vide keeps tough chuck juicy while the wine, bacon and aromatics soak in. The wine has to be reduced on the stove first: in a sealed bag the alcohol cannot evaporate, and raw wine gives the meat a harsh, metallic taste.

INGREDIENTS

- 1.4 kg (3 lb) beef chuck roast, cut into 5 cm (2 in) chunks
- 170 g (6 oz) thick-cut bacon, cut into lardons
- 1 bottle (750 ml) dry red wine, such as Pinot Noir or Burgundy
- 500 ml (2 cups) beef stock
- 1 large yellow onion, diced
- 2 large carrots, cut into thick coins
- 280 g (10 oz) cremini mushrooms, quartered
- 12–15 pearl onions, peeled
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 3 sprigs thyme and 2 bay leaves
- 2 tbsp butter mashed with 2 tbsp flour (beurre manié), plus 2 tbsp butter for the mushrooms
- Kosher salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. **Render the bacon.** Cook the lardons in a heavy pan over medium heat until crisp. Lift them into the sous vide bag and keep the fat in the pan.
2. **Sear the beef.** Pat the beef dry and season well. Over high heat, sear it in batches in the bacon fat, 1–2 minutes a side, until deeply browned. Add it to the bag.
3. **Build the base.** Lower the heat to medium. Soften the onion and carrots for about 5 minutes, then stir in the garlic and tomato paste for 1 minute. Add everything to the bag.
4. **Reduce the wine.** Pour the wine and stock into the hot pan, scraping up the browned bits. Boil hard for 10–12 minutes, until reduced by a third and no longer smelling of alcohol.
5. **Bag and seal.** Let the liquid cool a little, then pour it into the bag with the thyme and bay. Seal on a vacuum sealer's moist setting, or by water displacement in a heavy zipper bag.
6. **Cook.** Cook at 68 °C (155 °F) for 24 hours, with the bath covered to stop evaporation.
7. **Finish the garnish.** 20 minutes before the end, brown the mushrooms and pearl onions in 2 tbsp butter over medium-high heat.
8. **Thicken the sauce.** Strain the cooking liquid from the bag into a saucepan and bring it to a simmer. Whisk in the beurre manié a little at a time until the sauce coats a spoon.
9. **Serve.** Combine the beef and carrots with the sauce, mushrooms and onions. Garnish with thyme. Serve with mashed potatoes, buttered egg noodles or a baguette.